

Alamgiri Gate

عالمگیری دروازه

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Emperor Aurangzeb (regnal title Alamgir)
- Built in: 1673-74 CE
- Cost: Not documented in available sources
- Built for: The Mughal court and army - a grand formal western entrance large enough for a procession of elephants carrying the royal household

2. Construction Details

- Materials: Red sandstone masonry, twin semicircular flanking bastions
- Technique: Massive semicircular towers each topped with a domed pavilion (chhatri), a design meant to project imperial power at first sight
- Artisans/craftsmen involved: Not documented by name in available sources
- Time taken: Not documented; built within Aurangzeb's early reign, distinct from the earlier Akbari Gate

3. Historical Background

- Built as Aurangzeb's replacement for the older Akbari Gate as the fort's principal ceremonial entrance, facing what would shortly become the Badshahi Mosque (completed 1673) across the square now known as Hazuri Bagh.
- During the Sikh period and later British period the gate remained in continuous use; conservation work relaying its floor found three superimposed historic surfaces stacked on top of one another - Mughal-era pebble paving at the base, a Sikh-era burnt-brick floor above it, and a British-era small-brick floor on top - physical proof that three different empires resurfaced the same threshold without ever rebuilding the gate itself.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The Alamgiri Gate has appeared on Pakistani currency notes as a national heritage symbol.
- Its twin domed towers are wide enough that several elephants could pass through side by side - a deliberate design choice for royal processions, not just decoration.
- It stands as part of a larger monumental ensemble with the Roshnai Gate and the Samadhi (mausoleum) of Maharaja Ranjit Singh, all facing the same square.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Picture the square outside the gate at dawn in 1674: masons are still finishing the last of the chhatri domes overhead while, below, a line of caparisoned elephants waits to test whether the new archway is truly wide enough for the royal procession. Three centuries later, conservationists kneel in that same doorway, brushing dust off a floor that turns out to be three floors stacked one on top of another - Mughal pebbles, Sikh brick, British brick - each one laid by people who had no idea the layer beneath their feet had already been rebuilt twice before.

AI Heritage Revive — Lahore Fort landmark reference. Compiled from encyclopedic research report; figures marked "Not documented" are intentionally left blank rather than estimated.